

Brain-Based Mental Health Community

Parent Training Programs Feedback

NAME

DATE

Review the live website before providing feedback:

<https://tcfasd.github.io/Brain-Based-Mental-Health-/handout-therapy-guide.html>

Also known as: Parent Management Training (PMT), Behavioral Parent Training (BPT) **Varies by program | Brain-Based Fit:** Good V

What It Asks the Brain to Do:

Parent training programs teach caregivers specific skills to change the environment around a child's challenging behavior. The core idea: the caregiver is the primary agent of change. These programs restructure the environment so the child's brain gets clear, predictable signals (reducing confusion and anxiety), positive behavior gets noticed and reinforced (strengthening those neural pathways), and the caregiver-child relationship improves. They work primarily through environmental change and repetition — not by asking the child to think differently.

Caregiver Involvement:

The caregiver IS the client. The therapist works mainly with the caregiver, who then implements skills at home. This is the defining feature of all parent training programs.

Named Programs Under This Umbrella:

- Parent Management Training (PMT / Kazdin Model) — Ages up to 12
- Parent Management Training – Oregon Model (PMTO) — Ages 3–16
- Parent-Child Interaction Therapy (PCIT) — Ages 2–7
- Triple P (Positive Parenting Program) — Birth to 16
- The Incredible Years — Infant through age 12
- Helping the Noncompliant Child (HNC) — Ages 3–8
- Defiant Children / Defiant Teens (Barkley)

FASD-Specific Parent Training Programs:

- Families Moving Forward (FMF) — Specifically designed for FASD
- Parents and Children Together (PACT) — Also designed for FASD

How to Know If It Might Be a Good Fit:

- Your child's behavior is the primary concern and you want concrete skills to handle it
- You want to be the one doing the work, not waiting for a therapist to "fix" your child
- You want peer support from other caregivers (group-based programs like Incredible Years)
- For FASD specifically: ask whether the program has been adapted for brain-based differences, or look for FMF/PACT

Brain-Based Consideration

The environmental and behavioral approach is a strength for brain-based differences — these programs change the world around the child rather than expecting the child to change. However, standard parent training programs may need adaptation: expectations for speed of behavior change should be adjusted, reward systems may need to be simpler and more concrete, and caregivers need to understand the brain-based reasons for behavior — not just label it as "noncompliance." Programs designed specifically for FASD (like Families Moving Forward) have this understanding built in.

1. Is what is written accurate?

Yes

No

Yes

2. Is there additional information that you think caregivers should know about Parent Training Programs?

Thank you for your feedback!